



Sreeram Iyer
Chief Executive Officer
Scope International

As far as my organisation goes, telecommuting is clearly one of the desired strategic models of operating as a Shared Service Centre. For us, the benefits are three-fold: it leads to a better work / life balance for our staff, it enhances robust disaster recovery capabilities, and brings in a talent pool for the industry.

Security-related concerns had delayed the coming of age of the telecommuting model. However, security risks can now be better managed. As part of a large multinational bank, we adopt international standards in our security solutions, and going forward, we do see an improvement in our ability to adopt telecommuting for our operations.

HERE TO STAY?



Dadi Bhote
Executive Director
Hypersoft Technologies

Telecommuting is helping us enjoy cost benefits—office overheads, real-estate costs and infrastructure, retaining key employees, reducing operation costs, and more. This has resulted in raising productivity—to an extent. Also, employees benefit by a reduction in commuting time, efforts, and costs. Flexibility in work timings provides them full freedom to work at their own, convenient timings, and also meet assigned task deadlines.

One important reason for bringing in telecommuting was the ability to hire persons who would normally not be available to work out of an office, in cities where commute times are very long. The practice of such a strategy is possible today because the necessary infrastructure is available. Taking a break from our business operations for a moment, we are working on a new strategy for the expansion of our operations in the near future, with a capacity of about a hundred employees.



Chandrashekhar Nene
Vice President, IT
Kingfisher Airlines

This western concept is at a nascent stage in India, and is one of the models that benefits both the company and employees. Needless to say, along with telephony, the Internet, too, helps in the area of telecommuting. In populated metros such as Mumbai, Delhi, and Bangalore, a lot of people commute for more than two hours every day. Telecommuting can help not only in converting those man-hours to productive use, it also helps reduce traffic jams, pollution, accidents, and so on.

At the individual level, employees can maintain a balance between professional and personal obligations. This also affects work efficiency. If a person works more efficiently at home than in the office, the telecommuting option should be provided.

As told to Samir Makwana (samir_makwana@thinkdigit.com)